



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Getting Into Manuals



Learning Outcome:

Designs a user manual that fulfills both the IT solution needs and the client requirements.

Understand how to write a good user manual.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think a manual should have?
- Have you ever found a manual difficult to understand? What was it about?

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk with a colleague about the sections that must be included in the user manual.
- I can explain what to include in the description of system function section.
- I can describe the components of the operating instructions sections.





Let's Explore!

Zoe and Ethan are working out* how to do a manual.

* 'Work out' means to solve a problem



Instructions: Read the text below.

Zoe: Hey Ethan, I've been working in a manual. I hope you could help me.

Ethan: Hey Zoe, sure. What do you need?

Zoe: I'm not sure about the sections the manual should have.

Ethan: The first section of the manual often includes a cover page, copyright notices, and a table of contents. The body of the manual provides instructions and a guide about the main system of the product. The final part includes FAQs, a troubleshooting section, and contact information. Depending on the kind of product you've been working with, you may need a glossary explaining all necessary terms.

Zoe: I wish this product wasn't so complex. It sounds a bit complicated to write a manual for it.

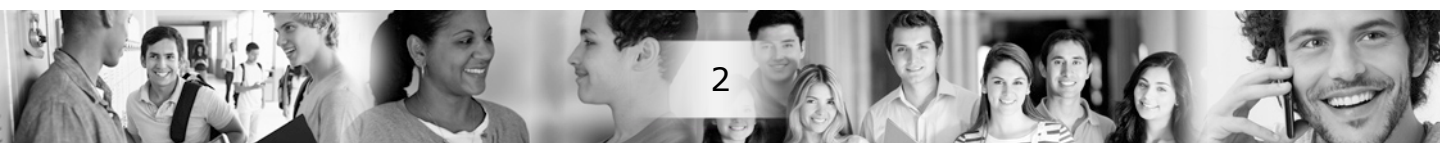
Ethan: I know, I wish we didn't have all this work.

Zoe: What should I include in the system function section? I haven't seen anything related with the business functions in the description of the system section, I think they have been placing this heading in the instructions section.

Ethan: That's one of the most important functions. You should describe your product specifically, including a title, a detailed description; in which you should point out the functions, and the execution functions associated to it. The inputs as well as the expected outputs might be separated sections, as they require specific data to be explained to the user. Finally, you should also have a results section; you might include graphics, texts and tables if you wish, the instructions of results and its limitations. Examples are noncompulsory, only if you consider they are needed.

Zoe: What about the sections of the operating instructions?

Ethan: They've been slipping them up into initiate operations, which set the initial parameters required, the maintain operation defines the procedures of intervention needed, and finally, terminate and restart operations define the procedures for normal termination of the system and restarting.





Let's Practice!

Zoe and Ethan have been having some trouble developing a user manual.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. hasn't / working / Zoe / been / in the / body manual. / of a user
2. Ethan / hasn't / added / section. / asked / question / a frequently
3. the final part. / haven't / They / been / doing / a glossary / for
4. hasn't / a troubleshooting / developed / section / yet. / Zoe
5. They / included / yet. / the copyright / haven't / notices



Let's Practice!

Ethan and Zoe wish the work required to do a manual wasn't that hard.

Instructions: Find the missing words for each sentence.

1. Common questions asked by users are F__.
2. A list of terms with meaning or explanation is a g_____.
3. Something n_____ is not mandatory.
4. The guideline of something is the p_____.
5. To p_____ o__ is to highlight it.
6. A synonym of break down is to s_____ u__.

X	Y	T	H	L	Z	N	O	J	S	Z	I	N	F	L
P	W	Y	N	X	A	W	Y	H	P	M	C	S	F	P
P	R	S	O	N	Q	J	V	Z	L	J	M	S	L	O
A	K	V	N	X	P	D	T	P	I	H	D	J	E	I
R	F	S	C	C	I	L	C	F	T	A	I	T	J	N
A	G	R	O	X	H	I	S	C	J	L	H	Z	R	T
M	N	I	M	F	O	J	H	D	Z	S	O	E	J	D
E	W	G	P	S	I	K	L	U	Z	K	F	K	S	H
T	X	R	U	Z	Q	G	L	O	S	S	A	R	Y	K
E	N	Y	L	P	N	C	J	X	Q	J	S	I	X	R
R	P	P	S	C	N	M	K	W	R	U	S	Q	T	N
B	R	I	O	G	A	W	A	W	A	D	X	A	G	A
J	E	R	R	W	L	H	F	S	U	Q	W	F	W	R
X	S	E	Y	S	N	O	G	Z	Y	G	P	U	R	M
C	E	Q	H	T	E	S	X	D	N	N	U	J	A	X



Extension Activity

Create a brief user manual!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Do some further research about the components required to create a user manual in info systems.
- Choose a simple computer program you know well.
- Write the layout of the user manual of that computer program.
- Write 10 general instructions to use the computer program you use and 5 frequently asked questions and answers.
- Share your manual with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I do some further research about user manuals. ☐ ☐
- I choose a simple computer program. ☐ ☐
- I write the layout of a user manual. ☐ ☐
- I write instructions questions and answers to use a computer program. ☐ ☐
- I share my manual with a partner. ☐ ☐



Target Words

- FAQ** (abbreviation): Frequently Asked Questions. Common questions asked by users.
e.g. The final part includes FAQs, a troubleshooting section, and contact information.
- glossary** (noun): a list of terms with meaning or explanation.
e.g. Depending on the kind of product you're working with, you may need a glossary explaining all necessary terms.
- noncompulsory** (adjective): something that is not mandatory.
e.g. Examples are noncompulsory, only if you consider they are needed.

- parameter** (noun): the guidelines or limits.
e.g. They've been divided into initiate operations which set the initial parameters required.
- point out** (verb): to highlight, indicate or show.
e.g. You should point out the functions, and the execution functions associated to it.
- split up** (phrasal verb): to divide or break down.
e.g. They've been splitting them up into initiate operations, which set the initial parameters required.



Learning Points

Present Perfect Continuous vs. Present Perfect- Negative Form

You can use the present perfect and the present perfect continuous to talk about actions that started in the past but continue to be true in the present.

The present perfect helps to express ideas that started in the past but still have a connection in the present.

The present perfect continuous emphasizes on an unfinished activity, while the present perfect focuses on an ended result. Take a look at the general structure:

Present Perfect Continuous

Subject + have/has + not + been + Verb in ING form

The manager hasn't been working hard to get the results on time.

Present Perfect

Subject + have/has + not + Verb in Past Participle

The company hasn't obtained the high quality reward.

Remember you can abbreviate:

Have not: haven't

Has not: hasn't

Examples

- *They've been slipping them up into initiate operations, which set the initial parameters required.*
- *I've been working in a manual.*





Learning Points

Wish + Past Form of Verb for Wishes for Present and Future- Negative Form

You can use the verb *wish* followed by a verb in Simple Past to talk about things you want.

We use the past tense to talk about wishes in the present, take a look at the following negative structure:

Subject + Wish + Subject + did not + Verb in Infinitive Form

Subject + Wish + Subject + was/were + not

Although the statement is in past simple, this type of sentences refer to wishes in the present and future.

Examples:

I wish this manual wasn't this long.

I wish I didn't have to assemble this computer.

Examples

- *I wish this product wasn't so complex.*
- *I wish we didn't have all this work.*